Design Thinking?

Design Thinking is a **human-centered problem-solving approach**.

Instead of starting with the solution, you start with the **people** (users), understand their needs deeply, then create and test solutions based on real insights.

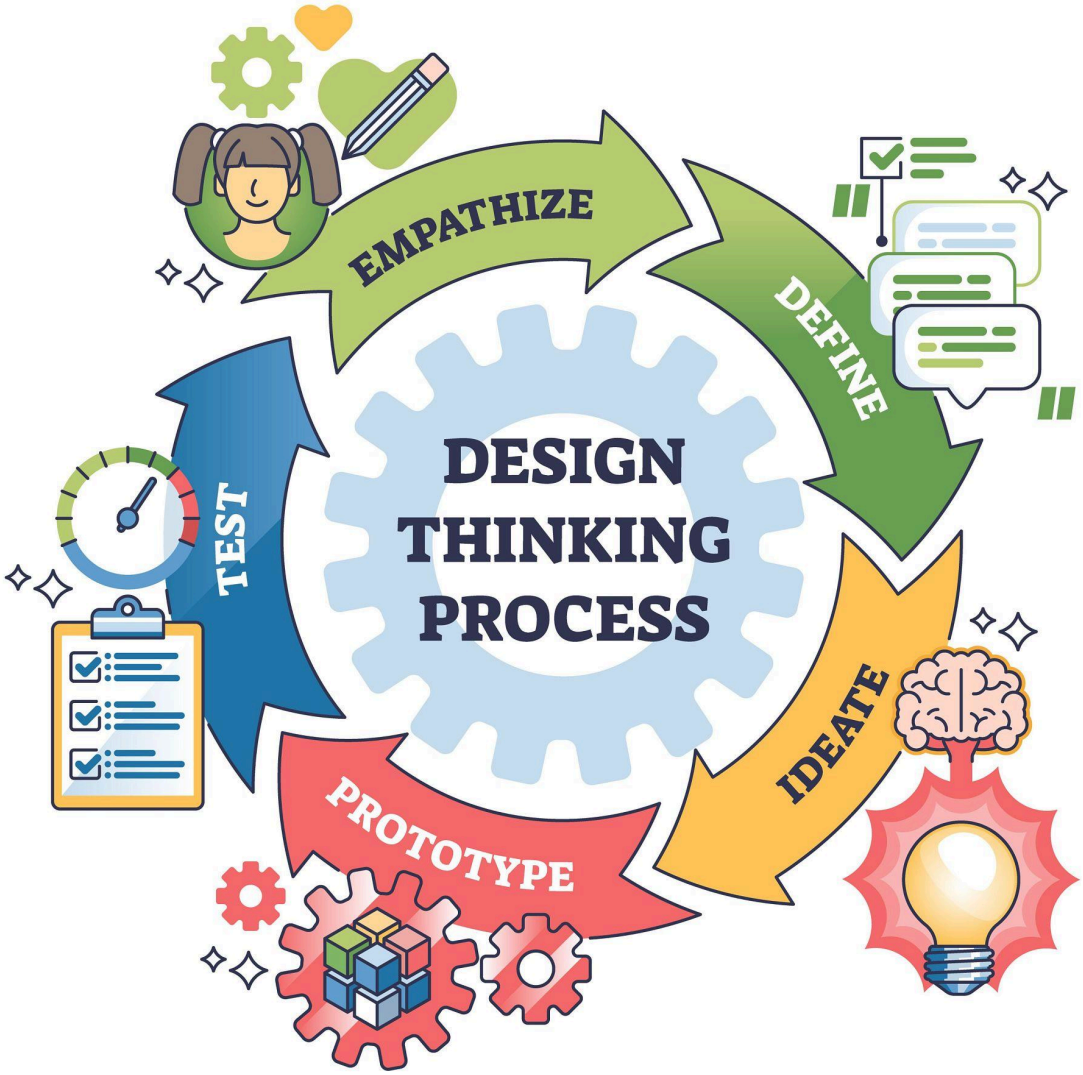
It is used in:

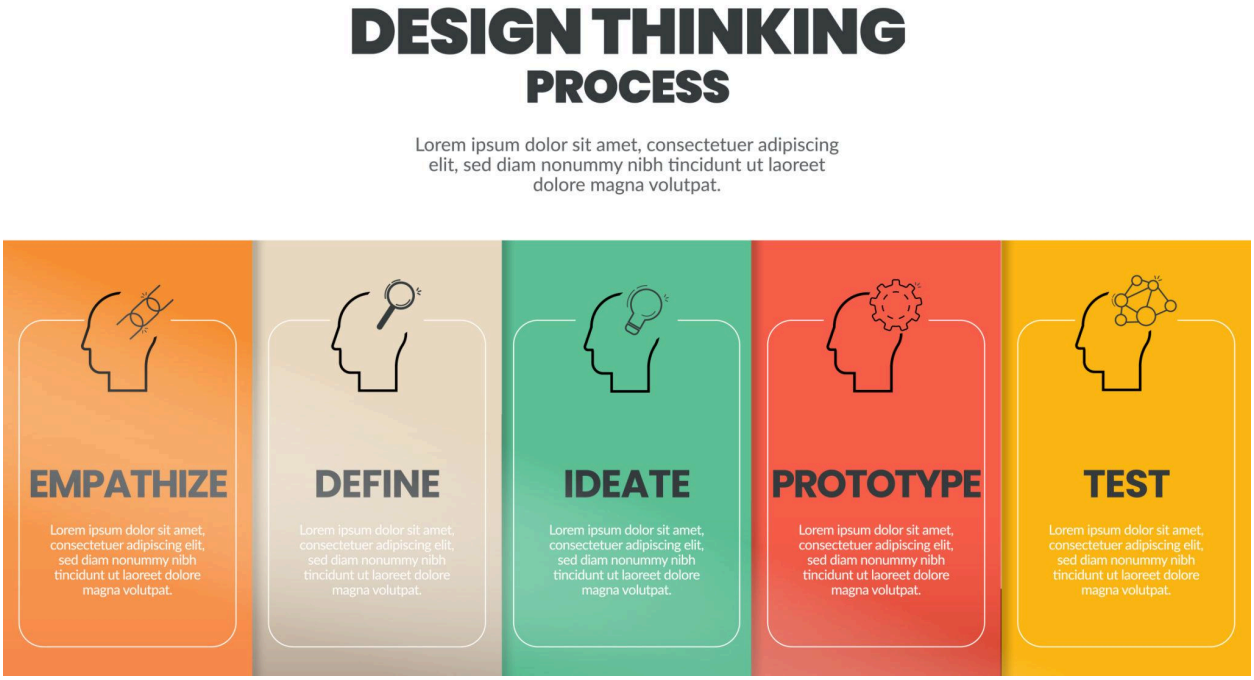
- Startups
- Product development
- UX/UI design
- Business innovation
- Even social and educational problems

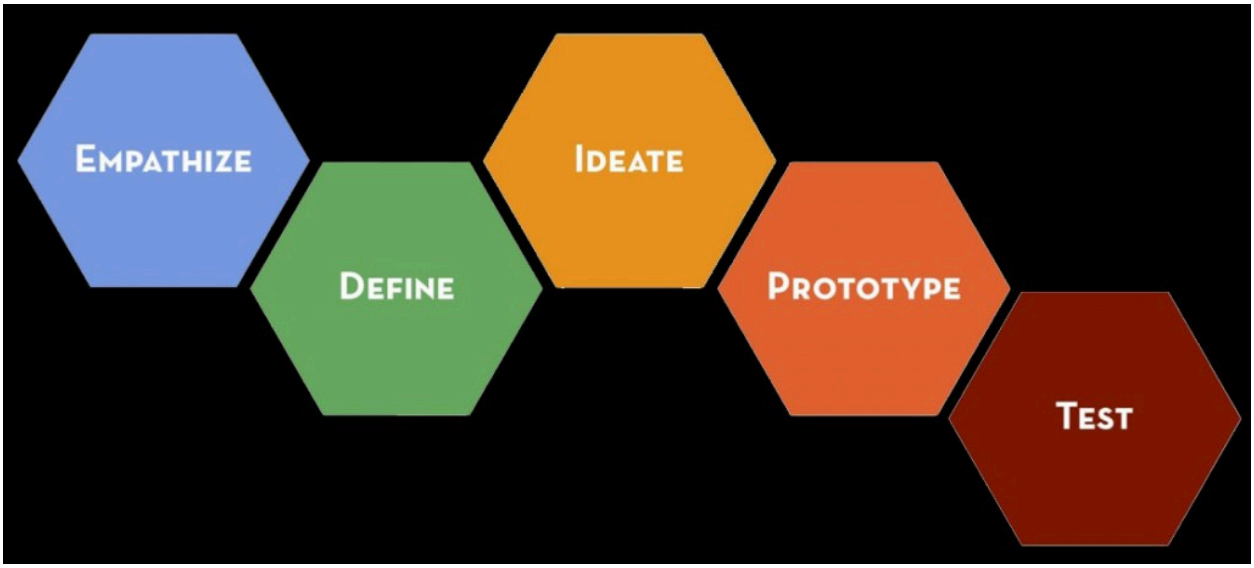
The main idea:

> 💡 Solve the right problem before building the solution.

The Design Thinking Process (5 Stages)


DESIGN THINKING PROCESS
EMPATHIZE
DEFINE
IDEATE
PROTOTYPE
TEST





1️⃣ Empathize

Understand the users.

- Interviews

- Observations
- Surveys
- Empathy Maps

Goal: Know their **real pain points**, emotions, and behaviors.

2️⃣ Define

Clearly define the problem.

You turn research into a clear problem statement:

> "Young students need a simpler way to manage study time because they feel overwhelmed and distracted."

3️⃣ Ideate

Brainstorm as many ideas as possible.

- No judging
- Quantity over quality at first
- Think creatively

Examples:

- Mobile app
- Gamified planner
- Smart reminders
- Study accountability partner

4️⃣ Prototype

Build a simple version of the idea.

- Wireframe
- Sketch
- Mockup

- Basic MVP

Goal: Make it testable quickly (don't overbuild).

5️⃣ Test

Let real users try it.

- Collect feedback
- See what works
- Improve it

🔁 It's iterative — you may go back to redefine or re-ideate.

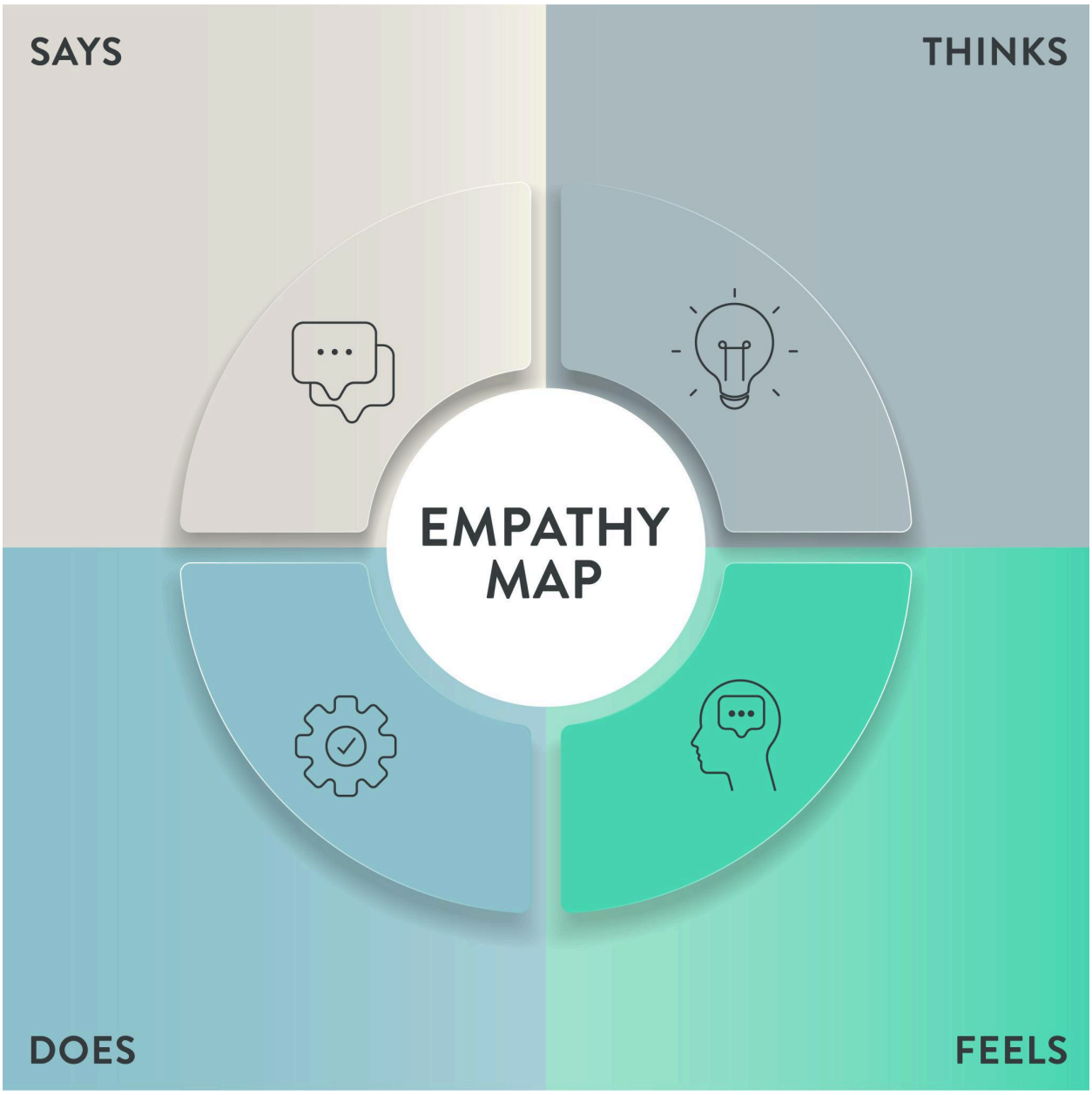
Applying an Empathy Map (Example)

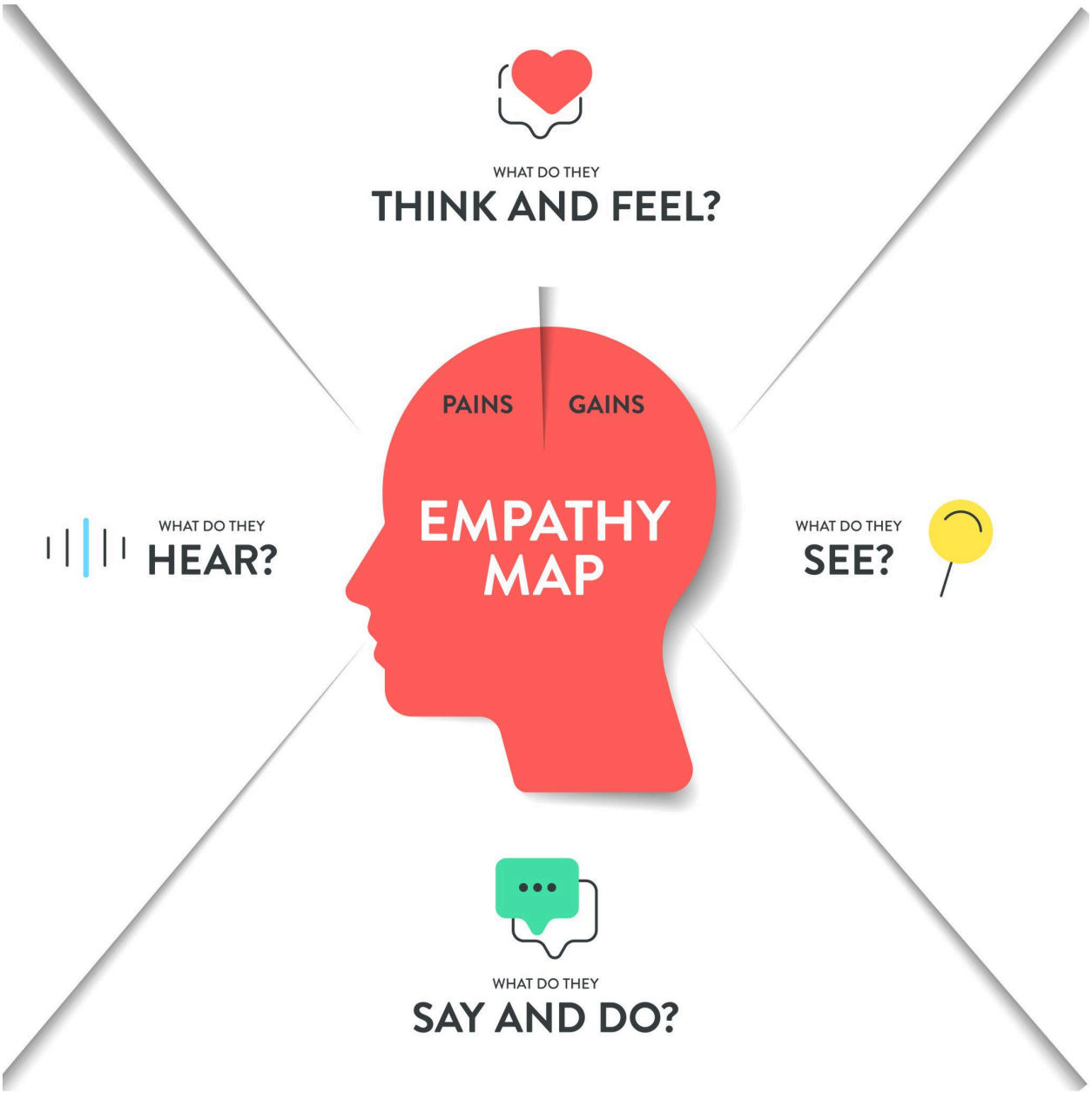
Let's apply it to a real example 👇

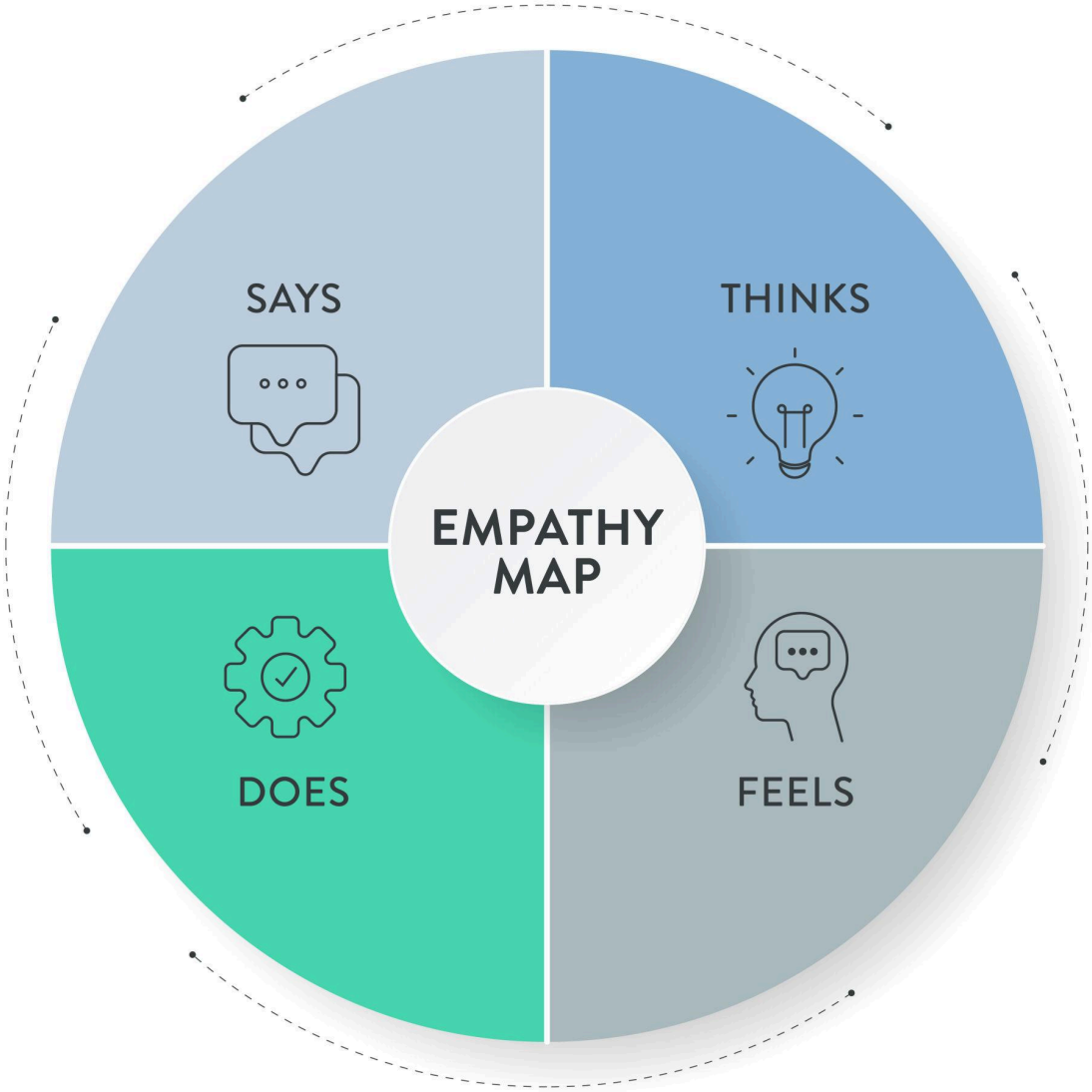
Scenario:

We want to build a **study planner app for university students**.

Empathy Map for "Ahmed – 21-year-old University Student"


SAYS
THINKS
EMPATHY MAP
DOES
FEELS


WHAT DO THEY
THINK AND FEEL?
PAINS
GAINS
EMPATHY MAP
WHAT DO THEY
HEAR?
WHAT DO THEY
SEE?
WHAT DO THEY
SAY AND DO?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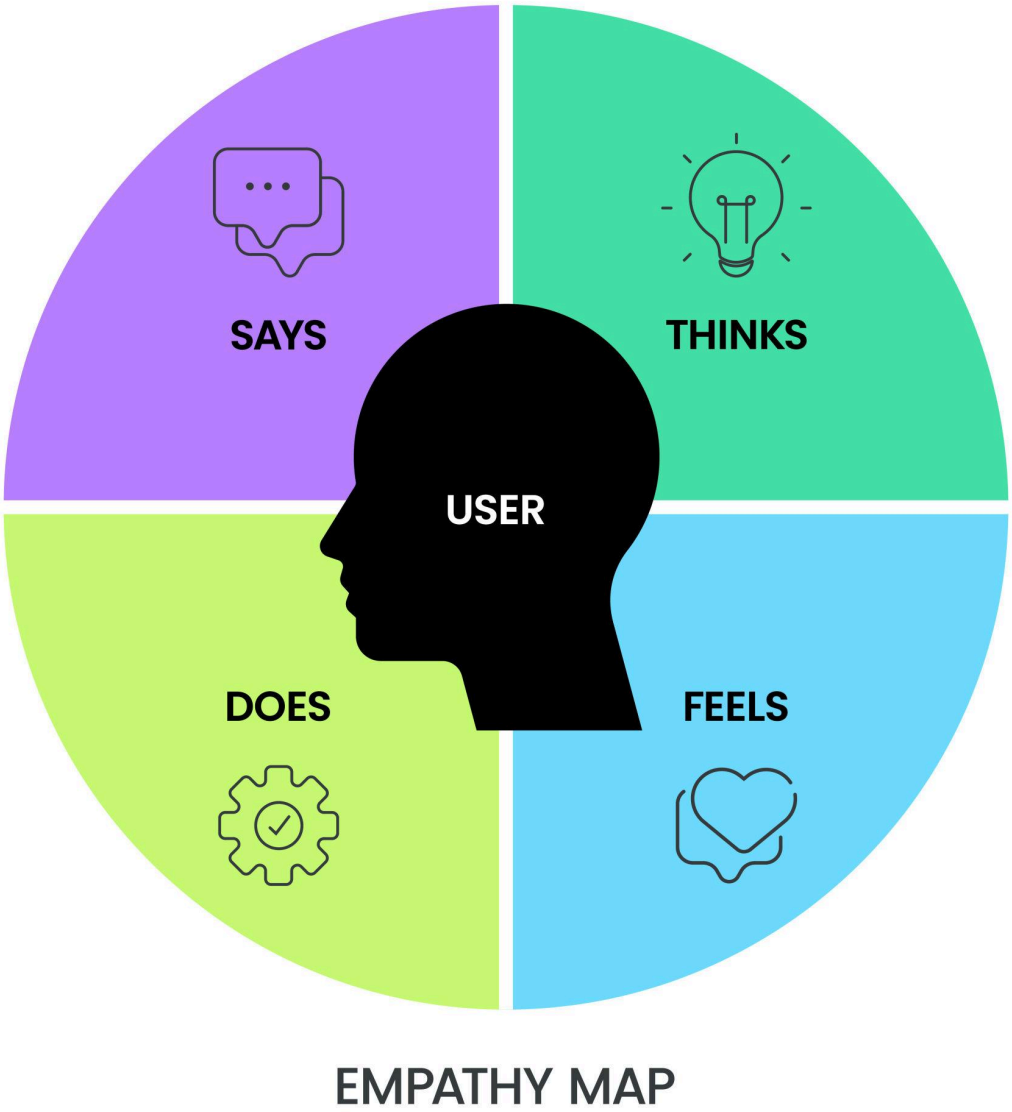

👀 What does he SEE?

- Friends posting productivity content
- Many assignments deadlines
- Complex planner apps
- Distractions (social media)

👂 What does he HEAR?

- “Grades are important.”
- “You must manage your time.”
- Friends saying they study 6+ hours daily

🗣️ What does he SAY & DO?

- Says: “I’ll start tomorrow.”
- Downloads productivity apps but deletes them
- Studies only before exams
- Complains about lack of time

🧠 What does he THINK & FEEL?

- Feels stressed and guilty
- Thinks he is bad at time management
- Afraid of failing
- Feels overwhelmed

😣 Pains

- Procrastination
- Distraction
- Overcomplicated tools
- Stress

🎯 Gains

- Simple planner
- Motivating reminders
- Progress tracking
- Feeling in control

Final Insight from Empathy Map

Instead of building a “feature-rich planner,”

we should build:

> ✅ A very simple, minimal, motivating planner
>
> ❌ Not a complex professional productivity system

That’s the power of Design Thinking —

you design based on **real human behavior**, not assumptions.